

**This assignment will not be graded and is only for practice.**

### Higher order partial derivatives:

Let  $f$  be a scalar valued function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^2$ . Then the second order partial derivatives are the partial derivatives of the partial derivatives.

#### Notations:

The partial derivative of  $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}$  with respect to  $x$  is denoted by  $f_{xx} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2}$ .

The partial derivative of  $\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}$  with respect to  $x$  is denoted by  $f_{yx} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y}$ .

The partial derivative of  $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}$  with respect to  $y$  is denoted by  $f_{xy} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y \partial x}$ .

The partial derivative of  $\frac{\partial f}{\partial y}$  with respect to  $y$  is denoted by  $f_{yy} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2}$ .

Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ . Then the second order partial derivatives of  $f$  are defined analogously as the partial derivatives of the partial derivatives.

**Notation:** The partial derivative of  $\frac{\partial f}{\partial x_i}$  with respect to  $x_j$  is denoted as  $f_{x_i x_j} = \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_j \partial x_i}$ .

**Note:** In general, the mixed partial derivatives  $f_{x_i x_j}$  and  $f_{x_j x_i}$  are not necessary equal.

**Clairaut's Theorem :** Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a scalar valued function defined on a domain  $D$  containing a point  $\underline{a} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ . If both  $f_{x_i x_j}$  and  $f_{x_j x_i}$  are defined and continuous in an open ball containing the point  $\underline{a} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ , then

$$f_{x_i x_j}(\underline{a}) = f_{x_j x_i}(\underline{a}).$$

**kth-order partial derivatives:** Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ . Then the  $k$ th-order partial derivatives of  $f$  are defined analogously by taking successive partial derivatives for  $k$ -times.

**Notation:** The notation for  $k$ th-order partial derivative is

$$f_{x_{i_1} x_{i_2} \dots x_{i_k}} = \frac{\partial^k f}{\partial x_{i_k} \dots \partial x_{i_2} \partial x_{i_1}}$$

**Modified statement of Clairaut's Theorem :** Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a scalar valued function defined on a domain  $D$  containing a point  $\underline{a} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$  whose  $k$ th-order partial derivatives are all continuous in an open ball containing the point  $\underline{a} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ . For any integers  $i_1, i_2, \dots, i_k$  between 1 and  $n$ , if  $j_1, j_2, \dots, j_k$  is a reordering of  $i_1, i_2, \dots, i_k$ , then

$$f_{x_{i_1} x_{i_2} \dots x_{i_k}}(\underline{a}) = f_{x_{j_1} x_{j_2} \dots x_{j_k}}(\underline{a}).$$

A consequence of this theorem is that **we don't need to keep track of the order in which we take partial derivatives.**

**Hessian matrix:** Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a scalar valued function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ . Then the Hessian matrix of  $f$  is defined as

$$Hf = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_1^2} & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_1 \partial x_2} & \dots & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_1 \partial x_n} \\ \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_2 \partial x_1} & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_2^2} & \dots & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_2 \partial x_n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_n \partial x_1} & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_n \partial x_2} & \dots & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_n^2} \end{pmatrix}.$$

$Hf(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  means that all of the entries of  $Hf$  are evaluated at the point  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ , which must be a point in the domain of  $f$ .

1) Find  $\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y}$  of the function  $f(x, y) = x^2 y^3 - xy + 6x + 8y + 1$ .

**1 point**

☐  $2xy^3 - y + 6$

- ☐  $3x^2y - x + 6$
- ☐  $6xy^2 - 1$
- ☐  $0$

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$6xy^2 - 1$

2) Find  $\frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2}$  of the function  $f(x, y) = x^5 + xy^7 + e^{xy}$  at point  $(1, -1)$ .

1 point

- ☐  $20 + e$ .
- ☐  $20 - e^{-1}$ .
- ☐  $20 - e$ .
- ☐  $20 + e^{-1}$ .

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$20 + e^{-1}$ .

3) Choose the correct statements about  $f(x, y, z) = -x^4 + 2x^2y^2z^2 - z^2y^4 + 2y^2 - xz^4 + 2z^2$ .

1 point

- ☐  $\frac{\partial^3 f}{\partial x \partial y \partial z} = 16xyz$
- ☐  $\frac{\partial^3 f}{\partial z \partial y \partial x} = 16xyz - 8zy^3$
- ☐  $\frac{\partial^3 f}{\partial z \partial y \partial x} = 16xyz$
- ☐  $\frac{\partial^4 f}{\partial z^4} = -24x$
- ☐  $\frac{\partial^5 f}{\partial y^5} = -24$
- ☐  $\frac{\partial^5 f}{\partial y^5} = -24z^2$

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$\frac{\partial^3 f}{\partial x \partial y \partial z} = 16xyz$   
 $\frac{\partial^3 f}{\partial z \partial y \partial x} = 16xyz$   
 $\frac{\partial^4 f}{\partial z^4} = -24x$

4) The determinant of the Hessian matrix of  $f(x, y) = x^2 + 3xy + 7y^2$  at point  $(x, y)$  is

**1 point**

- ☐ 28
- ☐ 19
- ☐ 0
- ☐ -19

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

19

5) Let  $A$  denote the Hessian matrix of the function  $f(x, y, z) = 3x^2 + xz + 2zy - z^2$  at  $(x, y, z)$ . Which of the following statements is (are) true?

**1 point**

- ☐  $A = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$
- ☐  $A = \begin{pmatrix} -6 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$
- ☐  $\text{Det}(A) = 24$
- ☐  $\text{Det}(A) = -24$

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 6 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\text{Det}(A) = -24$$

6) Let  $A$  denote the Hessian matrix of the function  $f(x, y, z) = x^2y - y^3z^2$  at  $(1, 1, 1)$ . Which of the following statements is (are) true? **1 point**

- ☐  $\text{Rank}(A) = 3$
- ☐  $\text{Rank}(A) = 2$
- ☐  $\text{Nullity}(A) = 1$
- ☐  $\text{Nullity}(A) = 0$

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

Rank ( $A$ ) = 3

Nullity ( $A$ ) = 0

**The Hessian test: Method for finding points of local maxima and minima for a scalar valued function of two variables:**

Let  $f(x, y)$  be a function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^2$ . Suppose that  $f(x, y)$  and its first and second order partial derivatives are continuous in an open ball around  $(a, b) \in D$  and  $f_x(a, b) = f_y(a, b) = 0$ . Then

$f$  has a local minimum at  $(a, b)$  if  $f_{xx}(a, b) > 0$  and  $\det(Hf(a, b)) > 0$ .

$f$  has a local maximum at  $(a, b)$  if  $f_{xx}(a, b) < 0$  and  $\det(Hf(a, b)) > 0$ .

$f$  has a saddle point at  $(a, b)$  if  $\det(Hf(a, b)) < 0$ .

The test is inconclusive at  $(a, b)$  if  $\det(Hf(a, b)) = 0$ .

7) Consider the function  $f(x, y) = x^3 + x^2y - y$ . Which of the following are correct?

**1 point**

☐  $(-1, \frac{3}{2})$  is a local minimum.

☐  $(-1, \frac{3}{2})$  is a saddle point.

☐  $(1, \frac{-3}{2})$  is a local maximum.

☐  $(1, \frac{-3}{2})$  is a saddle point.

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$(-1, \frac{3}{2})$  is a saddle point.

$(1, \frac{-3}{2})$  is a saddle point.

8) Choose the correct statement about  $f(x, y) = x^2 - y^3 - x^2y + y$ .

**1 point**

☐  $(0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}})$  is a saddle point.

☐  $(0, \frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}})$  is a local minimum.

☐  $(0, \frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}})$  is a local maximum.

☐ Hessian test is inconclusive at the point  $(0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}})$ .

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$(0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}})$  is a saddle point.

$(0, \frac{-1}{\sqrt{3}})$  is a local minimum.

9) Choose the correct statement about  $f(x, y) = 2x^3 + 6xy^2 - 3y^3 - 150x$ .

1 point

- ☐  $(5, 0)$  is a local minimum.
- ☐  $(-3, -4)$  is a saddle point.
- ☐  $(-5, 0)$  is a local minimum.
- ☐  $(-5, 0)$  is a saddle point.

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$(5, 0)$  is a local minimum.

$(-3, -4)$  is a saddle point.

### The Hessian test: Method for finding points of local maxima and minima for a scalar valued function of three variables

Let  $f(x, y, z)$  be a function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^3$ . Suppose that  $f(x, y, z)$  and its first and second order partial derivatives are continuous in an open ball around  $(a, b, c) \in D$  and  $f_x(a, b, c) = f_y(a, b, c) = f_z(a, b, c) = 0$ . Then

$f$  has a local minimum at  $(a, b, c)$  if  $f_{xx}(a, b, c) > 0$ ,  $(f_{xx}f_{yy} - f_{xy}^2)(a, b, c) > 0$ , and  $\det(Hf(a, b, c)) > 0$ .

$f$  has a local maximum at  $(a, b, c)$  if  $f_{xx}(a, b, c) < 0$ ,  $(f_{xx}f_{yy} - f_{xy}^2)(a, b, c) > 0$ , and  $\det(Hf(a, b, c)) < 0$ .

$f$  has a saddle point at  $(a, b, c)$  if  $\det(Hf(a, b, c)) = 0$  and cases 1 and 2 do not occur.

The test is inconclusive at  $(a, b, c)$  if  $\det(Hf(a, b, c)) = 0$ .

10) Consider the function  $f(x, y, z) = x^3 + xz^2 - 3x^2 + y^2 + 2z^2$ . Which of the following options are correct?

1 point

- ☐  $(0, 0, 0)$  is a local maximum.
- ☐  $(0, 0, 0)$  is a saddle point.
- ☐ Hessian test is inconclusive at the point  $(0, 0, 0)$ .
- ☐  $(0, 0, 0)$  is a local maximum.

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$(0, 0, 0)$  is a saddle point.

11) Choose the correct statements about  $f(x, y, z) = e^x(x^2 - y^2 - 2z^2)$ ?

1 point

- ☐  $(0, 0, 0)$  is a local maximum.
- ☐  $(0, 0, 0)$  is a saddle point.

☐ Hessian test is inconclusive at the point  $(-2, 0, 0)$ .

☐  $(-2, 0, 0)$  is a local maximum.

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$(0, 0, 0)$  is a saddle point.

$(-2, 0, 0)$  is a local maximum.

### Differentiability for scalar valued multivariable function:

Let  $f(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  be a scalar valued function defined on a domain  $D$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$  containing an open ball around a point  $\underline{a} = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ .

Then  $f$  is differentiable at  $\underline{a}$  if

$$\lim_{\underline{h} \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(\underline{a} + \underline{h}) - f(\underline{a}) - \underline{h} \cdot \nabla f(\underline{a})}{\|\underline{h}\|} = 0$$

12) Which of the following functions are differentiable at  $(0, 0)$ ?

1 point

☐  $f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$

☐  $f(x, y) = (xy)^{\frac{1}{3}}$

☐  $f(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{x|y|}{\sqrt{x^2+y^2}} & \text{if } (x, y) \neq (0, 0) \\ 0 & \text{if } (x, y) = (0, 0) \end{cases}$

☐  $f(x, y) = e^{x^2+y^2}$

No, the answer is incorrect.

Score: 0

Accepted Answers:

$f(x, y) = x^2 + y^2$

$f(x, y) = e^{x^2+y^2}$

Your score is: 0/12